OFFICIAL RECORD

From pig to man

How the animals' revolution slowly turned into the very thing they fought against.

1 Who's who

THE STORY BEHIND THE STORY

Orwell wrote *Animal Farm* as a fable about the Russian Revolution (1917) and Stalin's rule. Each animal stands for a real person or group.

ON THE FARM		IN HISTORY
Mr Jones *the careless farmer*	→	Tsar Nicholas II
Old Major *dreams of freedom*	→	Marx and Lenin
Napoleon *takes over*	→	Stalin
Snowball *chased away*	→	Trotsky
Squealer *explains everything*	→	State propaganda
The dogs *enforce fear*	→	Secret police
Boxer *works hardest*	→	Working people
The windmill *the big project*	→	Five-Year Plans

IN SIMPLE TERMS

It's a farm story on the surface, and a history lesson underneath.

2 What happens

THE PLOT IN EIGHT MOMENTS

○ HOPE ● THINGS GO WRONG

CH. I ○
Old Major dreams of a farm with no human masters.

CH. II ○
The animals drive out Jones and paint Seven Commandments.

CH. IV ○
They defend the farm; Snowball is a hero.

CH. V ●
Napoleon's dogs chase Snowball away. Debates end.

CH. VI ●
The pigs move into the farmhouse beds. The rules start to change.

CH. VII ●
Animals are forced to confess, then executed.

CH. IX ●
Loyal Boxer is sold to the knacker.

CH. X ●
The pigs walk on two legs and dine with humans.

IN SIMPLE TERMS

Freedom is won in Chapter II and lost, bit by bit, by Chapter X.

3 What we think

SIX READERS, SIX READINGS

Each member of our group asked a different question about the book. Together they add up to one warning.

SAYANJEET · MEMORY

Whoever controls the written record controls the past.

SAUNAK · HISTORY

Revolutions betray themselves: heroes become the next tyrants.

RISHABH · LANGUAGE

Propaganda works because language can be rewritten.

YASH · SYMBOLS

A society can't stay equal if its leaders aren't held accountable.

VAIBHAV · EQUALITY

Equality dies by small exceptions: milk, apples, a bed.

RAKTIM · LOYALTY

The most loyal are the first to be sacrificed.

IN SIMPLE TERMS

Power wins when people stop asking questions and stop remembering.

PIG
MAN
PIG?

"The creatures outside looked from pig to man, and from man to pig, and from pig to man again; but already it was impossible to say which was which."

THE LAST LINE OF THE BOOK · CHAPTER X

WHY IT STILL MATTERS

Power is rarely grabbed in one day. It grows through small steps, rewritten rules and silence, unless people ask questions and remember.

GROUP MEMBERS

SAYANJEET · SAUNAK · RISHABH · YASH · VAIBHAV · RAKTIM

SOURCES

George Orwell, *Animal Farm: A Fairy Story*. London: Secker & Warburg, 1945 (all quotations). Historical parallels: the novel's allegory of the Russian Revolution. Readings: our group.